



# Market Briefs **Pro**

*Read less news*

**Good morning, Pro Briefers!**

This week we've identified a Main Street Shift: Businesses are shifting their spending into artificial sweeteners, as consumers seek alternatives to traditional sugar products.

Let's break down how investors can take advantage of this opportunity.

In 1999, the average American consumed 158 pounds of sugar (an all-time record).

- That was a 30% increase from 1983.

Today, 66% of consumers want to eat healthier in 2025 and reduce their sugar intake from snacks, drinks, etc, according to Statista.

And this trend doesn't look like it's slowing down.

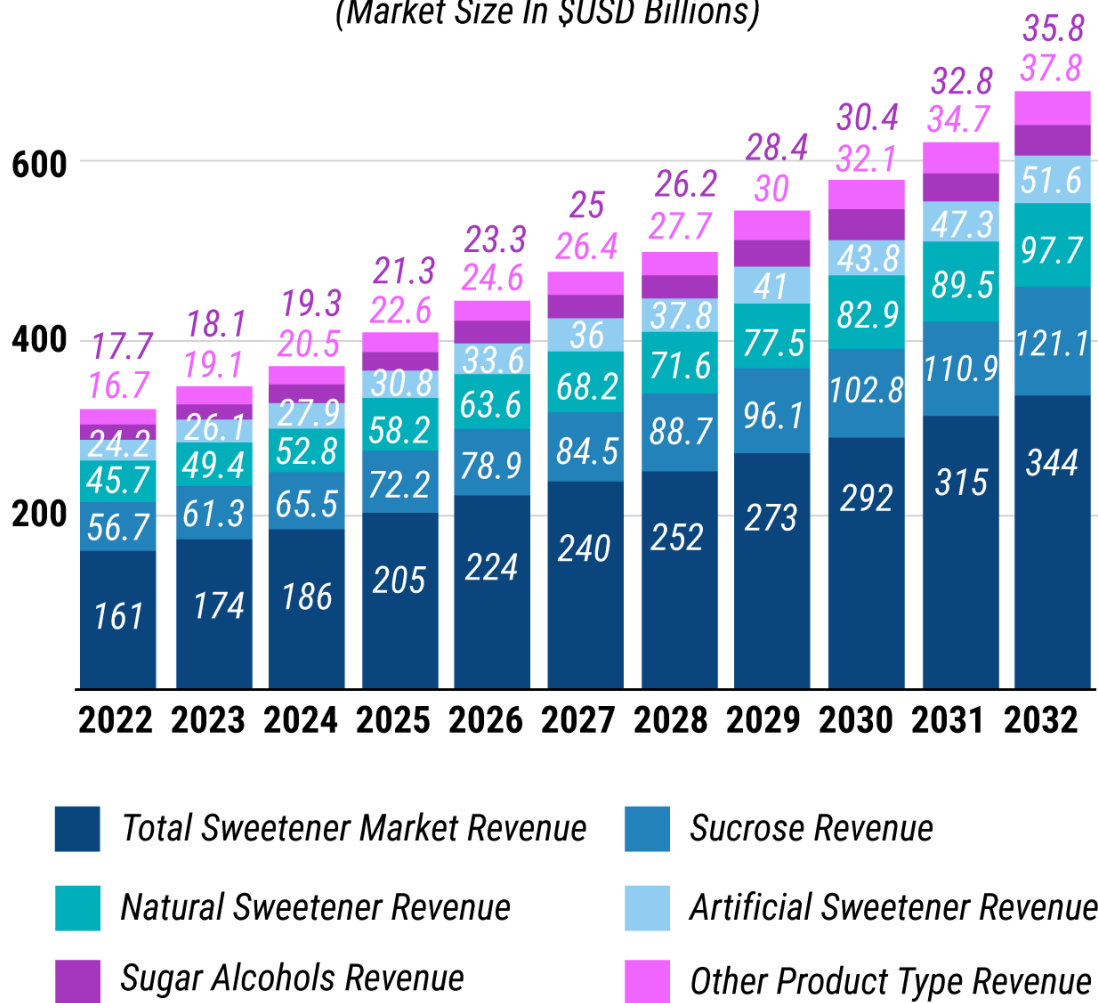
That's paved the way for artificial sweeteners.

Our Market Analysts spoke to University of Michigan endocrinologist Dr. Joyce Lee to understand this shift more.

"The number of products that are out there has increased substantially, just from a consumer perspective...so I assume that part of that kind of interest in those types of products has probably led to more use of the sweeteners overall." - Dr. Lee

# Global Sweetener Market Size – By Product Type

(Market Size In \$USD Billions)



Market Briefs Pro

Data via Market.us News

**Why does this matter?** Businesses are now producing food options with low or no sugar using artificial sweeteners like aspartame and sucralose.

**Definition:** Aspartame and sucralose are chemicals added to food to make things sweet without adding sugar and contain zero calories per serving.

- According to Straits Research, roughly 60% of all U.S. food contains artificial sweeteners like aspartame or sucralose.

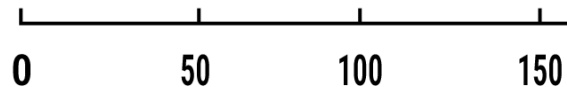
A study from the National Institute of Health found that 90% of companies that create low-sugar or sugar-free snacks use aspartame, sucralose, or both, to make snacks sweet without adding calories.

- Aspartame is 200X sweeter than sugar.
- Sucralose is 600X sweeter than sugar.

# Safe Levels Of Sweeteners

*How Many Packets Can A Person Consume And Still Be At The Safe Level For Each Sweetener Based On Its Sweetness Intensity?*

| Examples Of Brand Names Containing Sweetener                  | Sweetener                    | Number Of Sweetener Packets A Person Would Need To Consume In A Day To Reach The Acceptable Daily Intake (ADI): |                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Nutrasweet®<br>Equal®<br>Sugar Twin®                          | Aspartame                    | 75                                                                                                              |                                               |
| Sweet One®<br>Sunett®                                         | Acesulfame Potassium (Ace-K) | 23                                                                                                              |                                               |
| Splenda®                                                      | Sucralose                    | 23                                                                                                              | (Sweetness Intensity At 10,000 Times Sucrose) |
| Newtame®                                                      | Neotame                      | 23                                                                                                              |                                               |
| Advantame®                                                    | Advantame                    | 4,920                                                                                                           |                                               |
| Sweet And Low®<br>Sweet Twin®<br>Sweet'N Low®<br>Necta Sweet® | Saccharin                    | 45                                                                                                              | (Sweetness Intensity At 400 Times Sucrose)    |
| Truvia®<br>PureVia®<br>Enliten®                               | Steviol Glycosides           | 27                                                                                                              | (Sweetness Intensity At 300 Times Sucrose)    |



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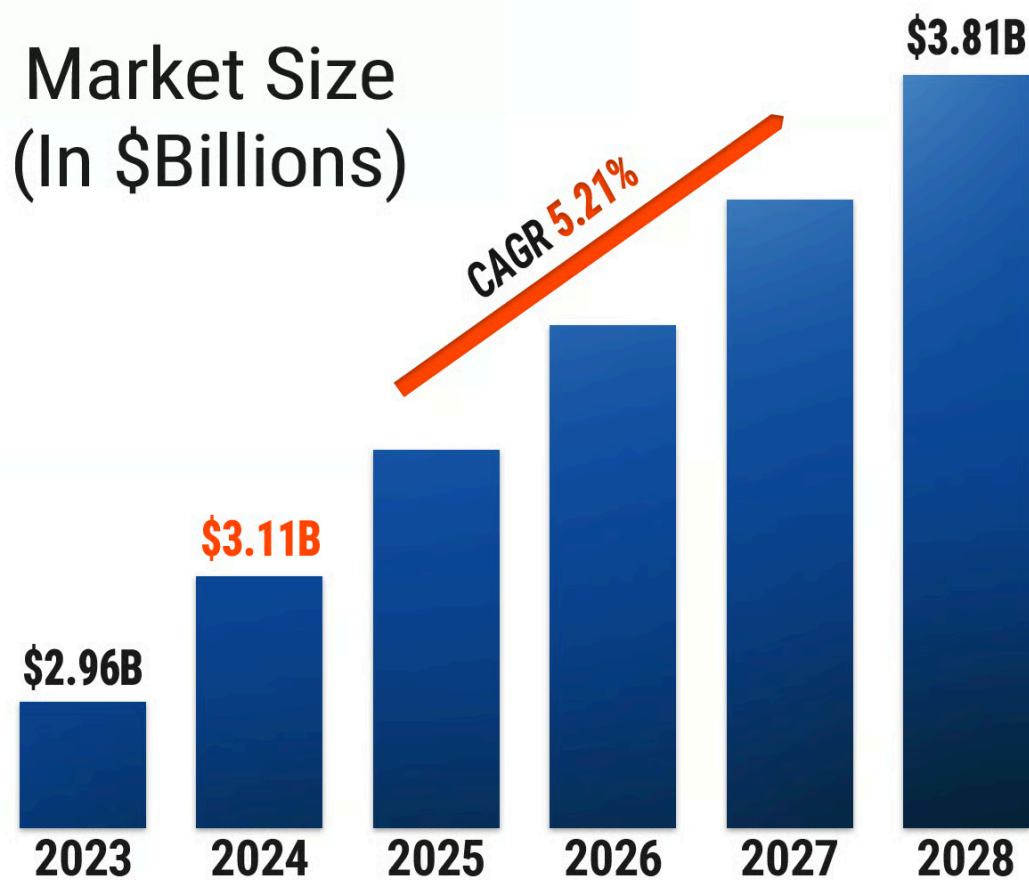
Data [via](#) FDA

Both are FDA-approved sugar alternatives and are widely used in products like Coke Zero Sugar, Splenda, and Jell-O.

Artificial sweeteners as a market is expected to grow to \$3.8 billion by 2032 as well, up from \$2.9 billion in 2023.

As a result, many companies that are essential in creating artificial sweeteners like aspartame and sucralose have seen a rise in profit as demand rises for sugar alternatives.

# High-Intensity Artificial Sweeteners Global Market Report 2024



 Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) The Business Research Company

**Keep in mind:** We're not doctors - so we aren't here to tell you if aspartame or sucralose are good or bad for you. Instead, we want to show investors how the money is shifting.

That's why in this report, we are going to illustrate how artificial sweetener producers, ingredient suppliers, and equipment manufacturers are gaining profit from this Main Street Shift.

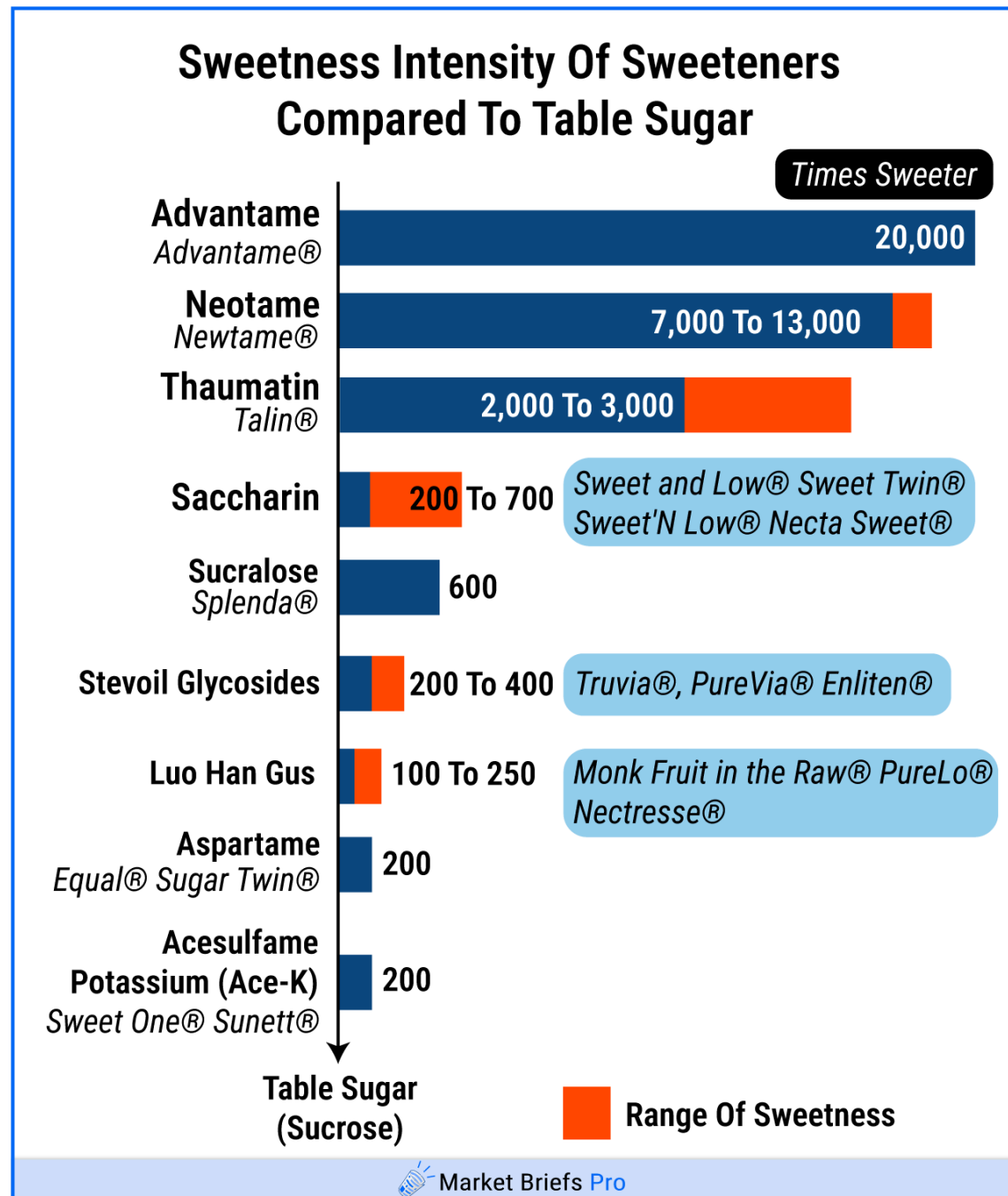
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## Producers

Because artificial sweeteners are so sweet, companies can use less per snack or drink to achieve the same level of sweetness that sugar can provide.



Data via FDA

**Why does this matter?** Aspartame is much more expensive than sugar.

- Aspartame costs roughly \$10 per pound to produce, while sugar only costs around 38 cents per pound.

So, if one can of Coke has 39 grams of sugar, it would need less than 0.5 grams of sucralose and 2 grams of aspartame to achieve the same level of

sweetness.

Dr. Lee affirmed this when our analysts sat down with her:

"We all probably need to eat less sugar, so, I think artificial sweeteners and natural sweeteners are a way to try and do that...you will see a insulin spike with the regular sugars, but you will see less of a rise with these sweeteners."

However, aspartame and sucralose are made with artificial ingredients, which means more can be produced, and because they're so sweet, less is used per product, which saves businesses money.

Artificial sweeteners are also used in more than just food as well - they can be found in toothpaste, mouthwash, and medications.

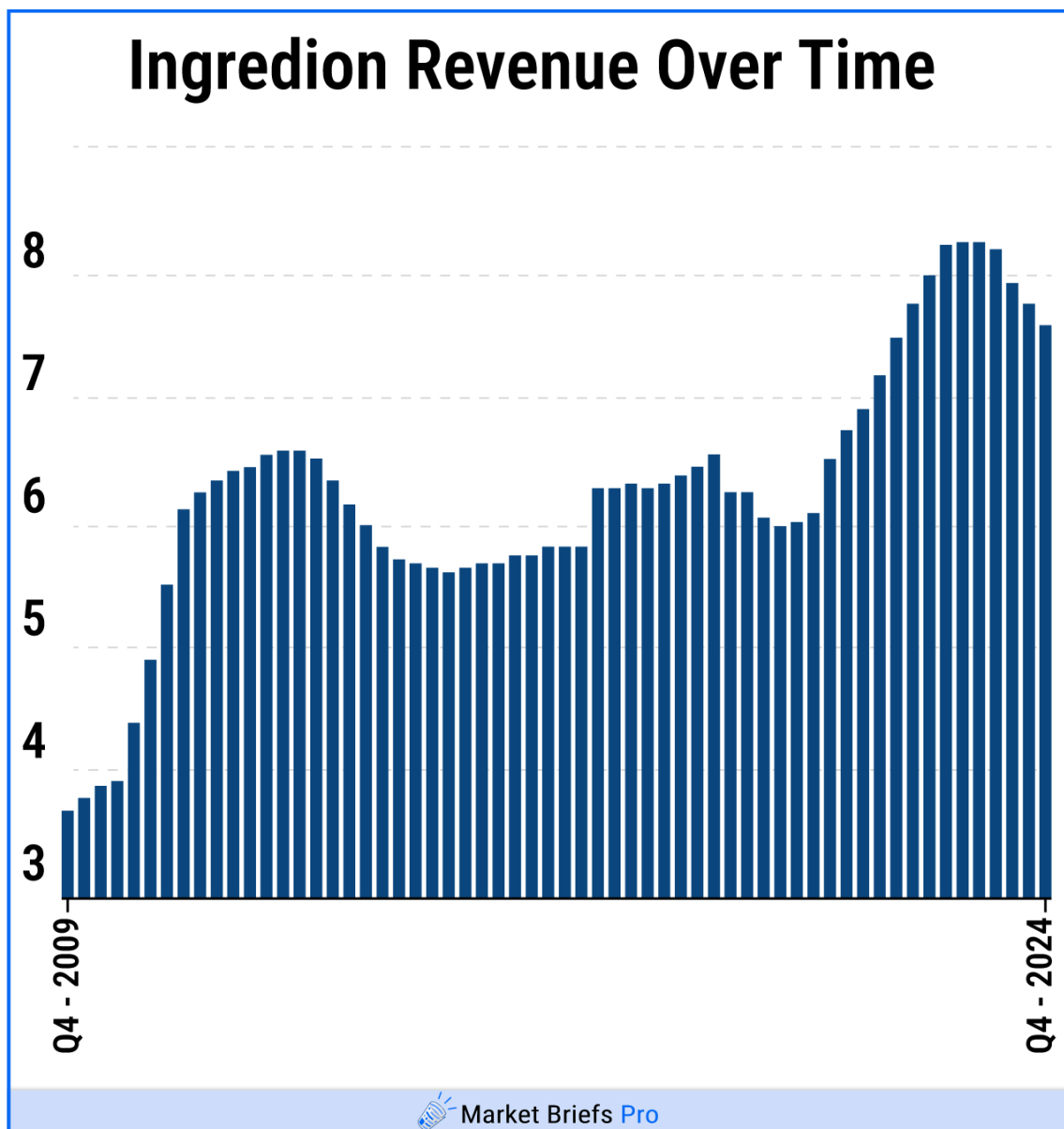
As a result, artificial sweetener usage in our food and other food-based products like toothpaste has increased by 20% since 2022, according to Science Direct.

One of the largest producers of artificial sweeteners is Ingredion Incorporated (INGR).

Ingredion provides ingredients to other brands so they can make snacks - in this case, Ingredion combines raw ingredients together to create aspartame and sucralose.

- Some of its biggest customers include PepsiCo (PEP), General Mills (GIS), and The Hershey Company (HSY).

Ingredion even has its own proprietary artificial sweetener called Dulcent, which contains aspartame.



Data via [Macrotrends](#) - above chart in \$billions

It also sells stevia to companies for them to incorporate into their foods - stevia combines natural sugar with artificial sweeteners.

In 2023, Ingredion brought in its biggest revenue ever at around \$8 billion for the second straight year.

- That was an increase from around \$6 billion in revenue from 2021.

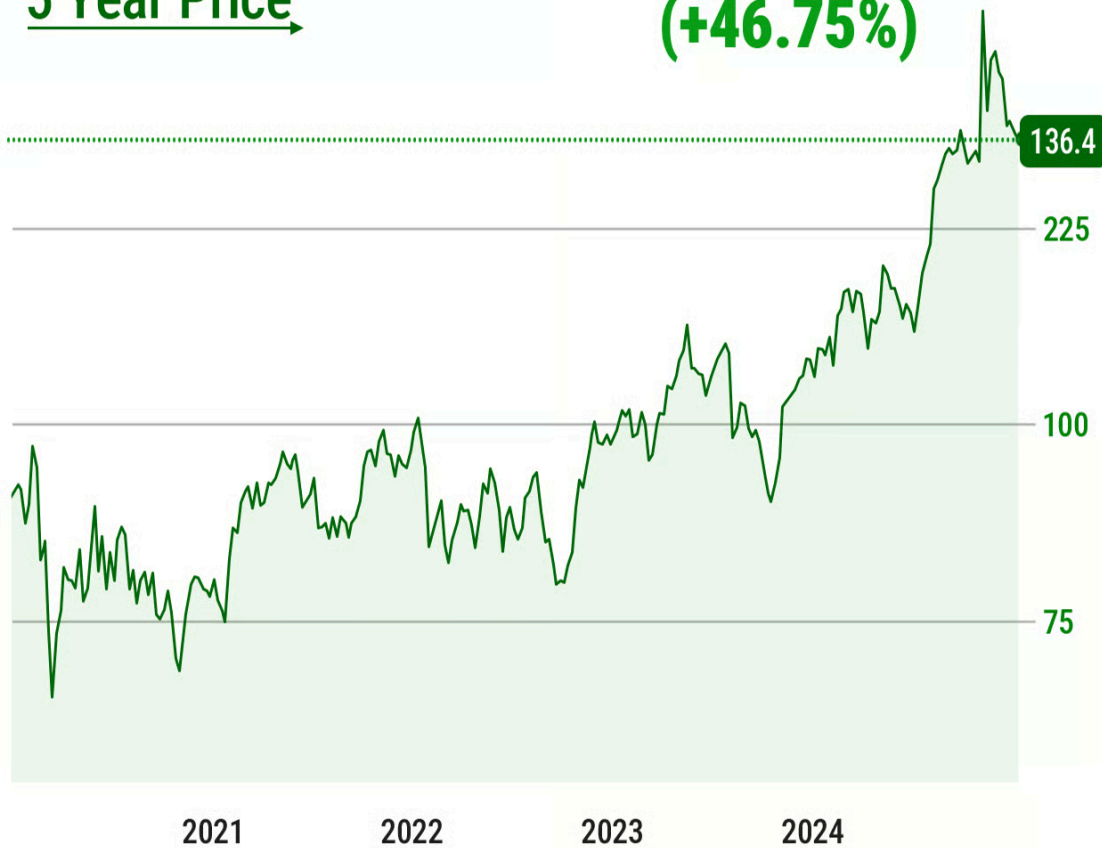
However, the company's revenue slipped to just under \$7.5 billion in 2024 - the company cited inflation putting pressure on prices as the main cause of its revenue drop.

Aspartame is only part of Ingredion's revenue stream, as it also produces high fructose corn syrup, corn starch, and other essential ingredients for snack makers.

# Ingredion Incorporated (INGR)

5 Year Price →

**136.4**  
**(+46.75%)**



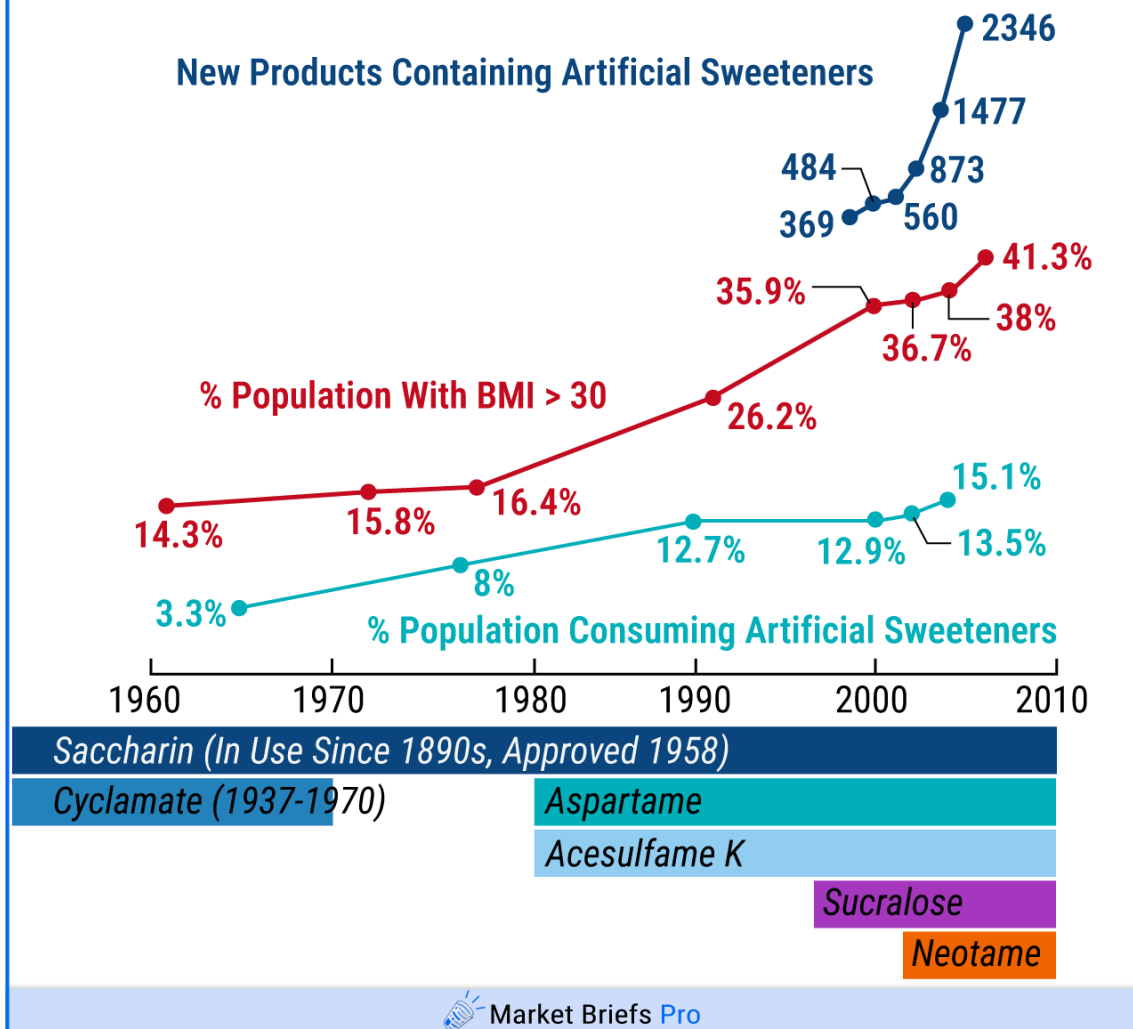
 **Market Briefs Pro**

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Still, Ingredion is a primary producer of aspartame and sucralose, which means its revenue opportunities will grow alongside demand for alternative sweeteners.

- Ingredion launched a drop-in stevia-based product in 2023, the first of its kind, that can add artificial sugar to food like cake.

## Trends In Artificial Sweetener Use, Obesity, And Product Availability (1960–2010)



Data via Mintel Market Analysis

Celanese (CE), a food-grade chemical supplier, has also seen its revenue rise in recent years due to the demand for artificial sweeteners rising.

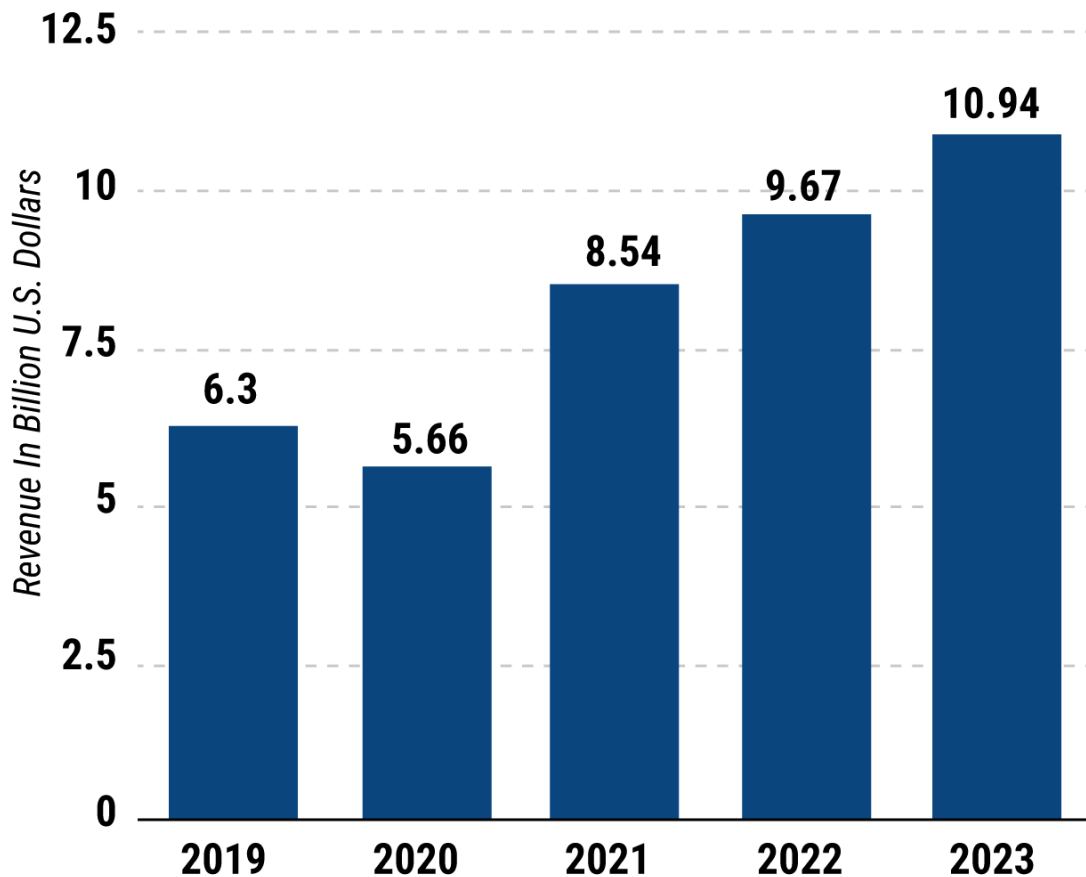
- Celanese reported a record-high \$10.9 billion in revenue in 2023. In 2024, its revenue fell slightly to \$10.4 billion, its second highest ever.

**Why the drop?** Demand for its non-food grade chemicals (for things like paint), fell last year, despite its food-grade chemical sales rising.

Celanese does not produce aspartame or sucralose directly, but it does combine the chemical with its own ingredients to make another type of alternative sweetener.

# Revenue Of Celanese From 2019 To 2023

(In \$Billion U.S. Dollars)



 Market Briefs Pro

Data via Statista

Sunett Ace-K is an artificial sweetener that blends potassium and aspartame together to create a new type of sweetener that offers a different flavor, no calories, and cheaper costs to snack businesses.

Because it uses even less aspartame, this artificial sweetener is able to sweeten products at a fraction of the cost.

- Sunett Ace-K has been approved by the FDA for use in foods since 1998.

In addition to its cost savings, the process to create Sunett Ace-K is less complex, meaning Celanese can produce more of it with fewer steps than it takes to make aspartame.

It's now also making a similar product that combines potassium and sucralose, which allows it to make artificial sweeteners more effectively.

# Celanese Corporation (CE)

5 Year Price →

**68.03**  
**(-43.98%)**



 Market Briefs Pro

Data via Yahoo! Finance

**The point?** Sunett Ace-K is designed to mimic sugars' natural taste and contains no calories.

- The sweetener is mostly used in food-grade products like toothpaste and mouthwash to enhance taste.

This has allowed Celanese to become a major player in the artificial sweetener market while taking advantage of the demand that aspartame and sucralose have created.

Ingredion and Celanese are two of the biggest public companies that produce artificial sweeteners today, creating opportunities for investors to profit.

There are also funds like the First Trust Consumer Staples AlphaDEX Fund (FXG) that can give investors broad exposure to the market.

# First Trust Consumer Staples AlphaDEX Fund (FXG)

5 Year Price →

**64.06**  
**(+28.02%)**



 **Market Briefs Pro**

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

## Ingredient Suppliers

Celanese and Ingredion take raw chemicals and combine them together to make artificial sweeteners like aspartame and sucralose.

But they often don't produce the raw chemicals themselves, meaning they also have ingredient suppliers.

"We used to just think about the artificial sweeteners as sort of the typical option, but now you've got sort of more of these plant derived natural sweeteners like alulose or monk fruit and so those are getting sort of more popular in the market. And then we also have the sugar alcohols like erythritol." - Dr. Lee

**Fun fact:** Aspartame and sucralose are made when two amino acids are put together - phenylalanine and aspartic acid.

- Producers then take these amino acids and cook them together, which creates a sweet taste.

## Relative Sweetness of Common Sweeteners and Their Brand Names

| Sweet Substance | Brand Name             | Relative Sweetness |
|-----------------|------------------------|--------------------|
| Sucrose         | None                   | 1                  |
| Glucose         | None                   | 0.7                |
| Fructose        | None                   | 1.3 - 1.8          |
| Saccharin       | Sweet'N Low, SugarTwin | 300                |
| Aspartame       | NutraSweet, Equal      | 200                |
| Sucralose       | Splenda                | 600                |

 **Market Briefs Pro**

Data [via](#) The Mountaineer

- Sucrose is the chemical name for table sugar.

However, to get these amino acids and other chemicals needed to create artificial sweeteners, producers rely on ingredient suppliers like Bunge Limited (BG) (*this will be important later*).

**Breakdown.** Bunge is in the business of agriculture, which basically means it runs massive plantations that grow essential crops like wheat, soybeans, and other plants.

The company can take many of these plants and sell them directly to other companies so that they can create other food products.

In many cases though, Bunge synthesizes its crops to extract the amino acids needed to create some artificial sweeteners.

*Remember those amino acids from before? They are commonly derived from legumes - like soybeans.*



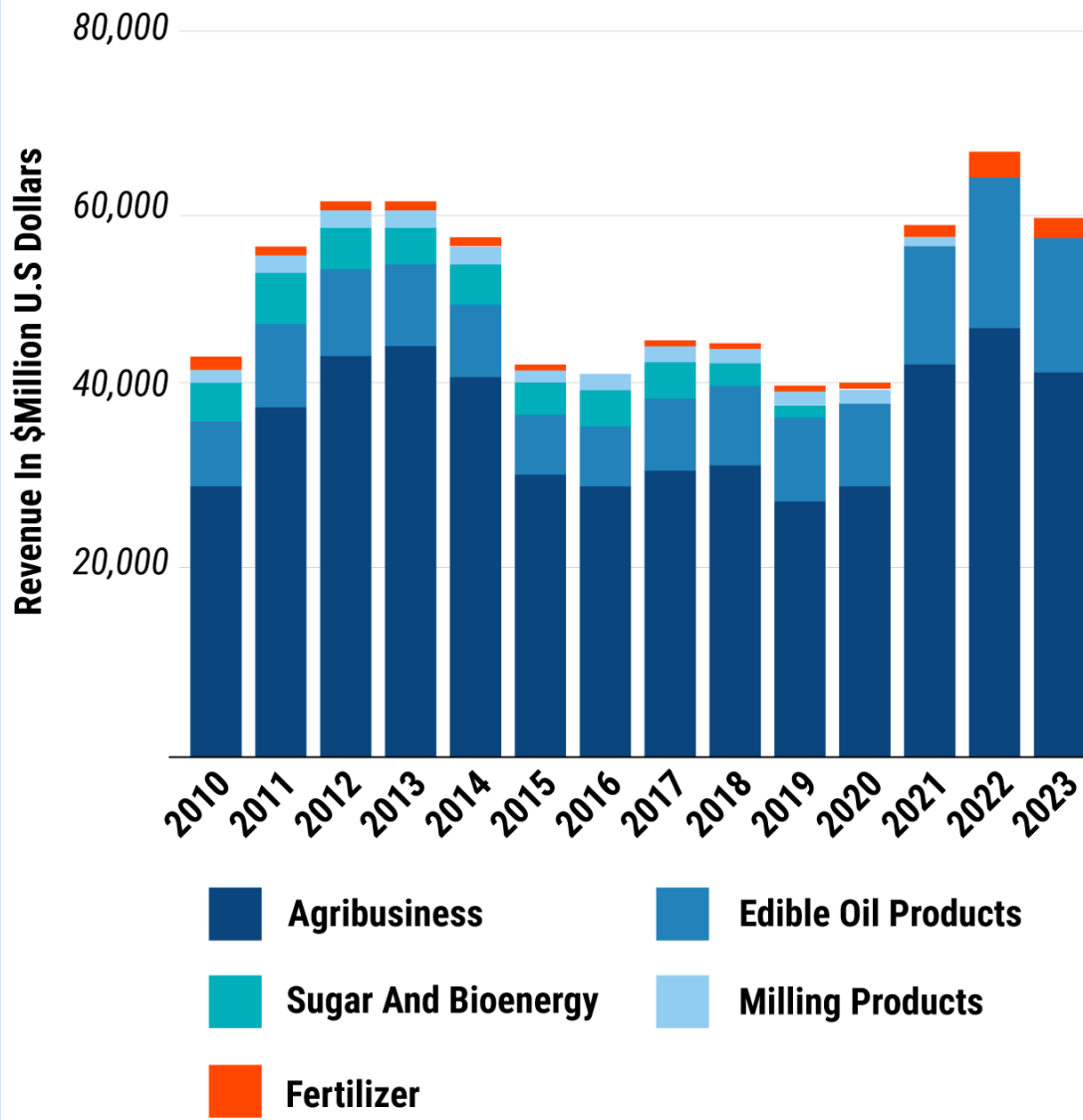
Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Bunge Limited is one of the largest owners of soybean plantations in the world and has a strong presence in the top three soybean-producing nations: Brazil, Argentina, and the U.S.

In 2022, Bunge recorded over \$60 billion in revenue, its highest ever - its revenue fell to \$59 billion in 2023, and dropped again to \$55 billion in 2024.

**Why the dip?** Droughts and plant diseases hurt its crops, limiting its production and raising its costs.

## Bunge Limited's Net Sales From 2010 To 2023, By Segment (In \$Million U.S. Dollars)



Market Briefs Pro

Data via Statista

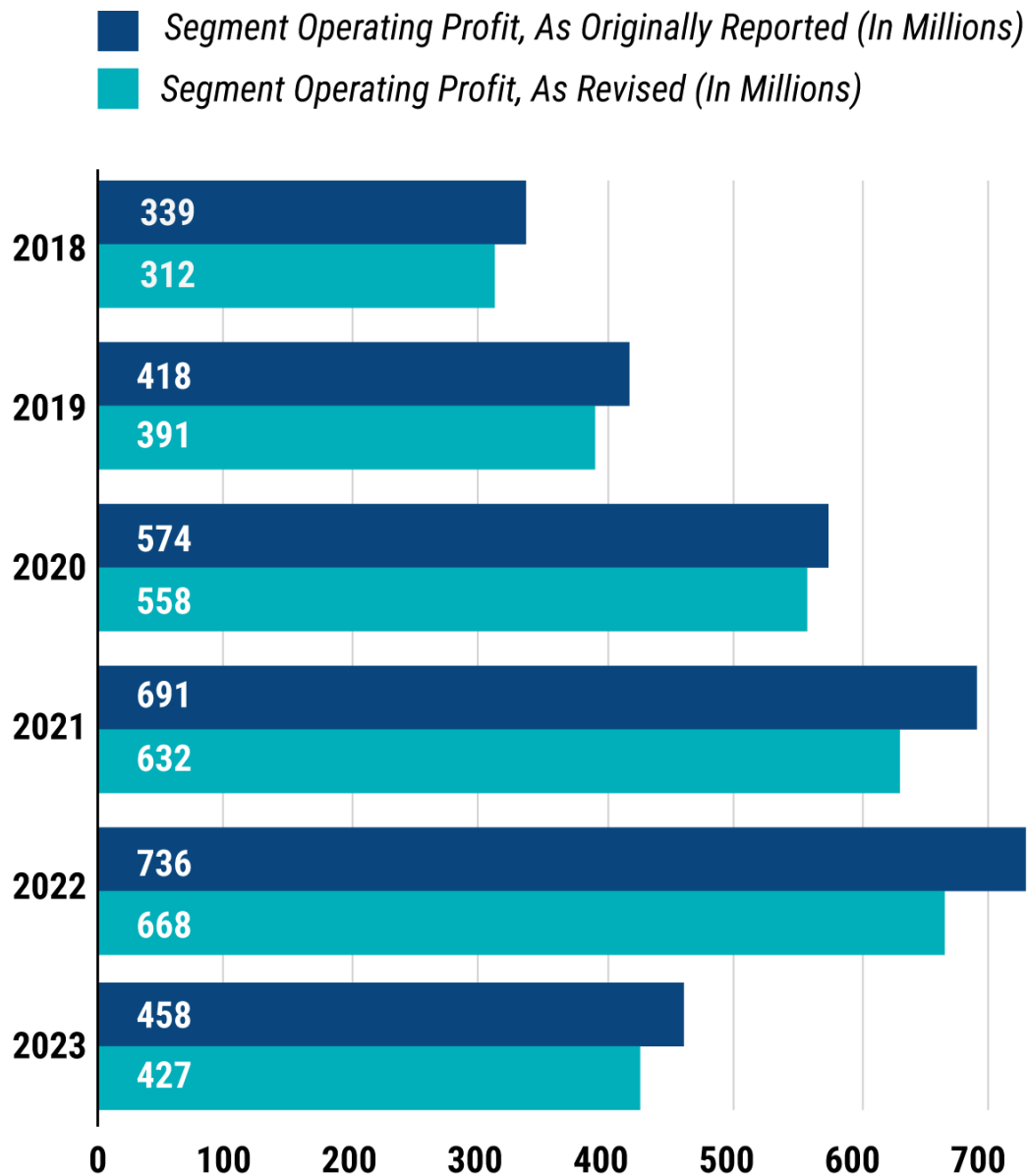
Archer Daniels Midland (ADM) also helps provide aspartame and sucralose producers with the chemicals they need to make the substances.

- The company also helps turn crops into foods, and owns corn, soybean, and peanut farms around the world.

Stevia uses both real sugar and artificial sugars, but is sourced from the Stevia Rebaudiana plant.

The plant is naturally found in South America, but is now grown in places like China, the U.S., and Paraguay.

## Revised Earnings For ADM's Nutrition Division



 Market Briefs Pro

Data via ADM

Archer Daniels Midland is one of the largest owners of stevia plantations in the world.

It sells the stevia extract to aspartame and sucralose producers and other artificial sweetener companies.

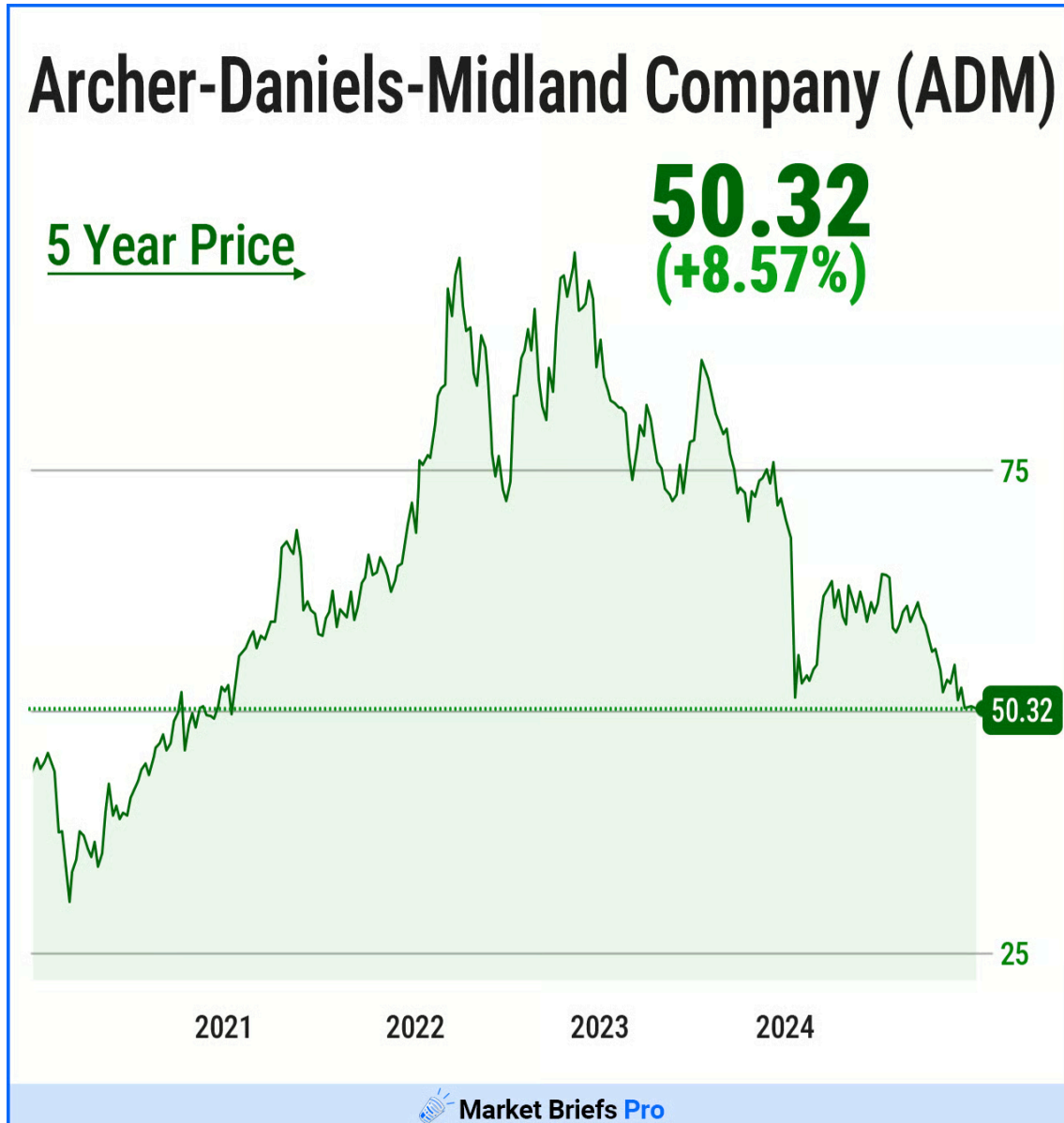
ADM increased its operating profit every year from 2020-2022, as it jumped from \$558 million to \$668 million.

In 2023, ADM saw its operating profit fall to \$427 million and it dipped again to \$298 million in 2024.

- 53% of ADM's plantations are in Brazil, which saw sales drop due to natural disasters and a lower than usual harvest last year.

While not as high in demand as direct aspartame and sucralose, stevia is still a popular artificial sweetener globally.

- Stevia makes up between 8-9% of the total artificial sweeteners market according to Straits Research.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- The stevia market is expected to grow 9% each year from \$775 million to \$1.6 billion by 2029.

And with ADM as one of the major producers of stevia, this means it's positioned to potentially grab those profits as demand for artificial sweeteners rises.

Bunge and ADM can expose investors to opportunities in the artificial sweeteners market by investing in chemical companies that help make the

sweeteners.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

The SPDR S&P North American Natural Resources ETF (NANR) can also help investors diversify across the entire agricultural and food chemicals industry.

### DEEP BRIEF

## Facilities and Equipment

Aspartame, stevia extract, and sucralose can't be made without the right facilities and equipment.

And because demand is rising for these alternative sweeteners, there is now an entire industry that provides the equipment to manufacture them

properly.

Thermo Fisher (TMO) provides producers and suppliers in the artificial sweetener space with high-performance liquid chromatography tools and specialized reagents.

**In English:** These tools measure the purity of aspartame and sucralose as well as ensure machines are calibrated to produce safe, edible sweeteners.

Dr. Joyce Lee discussed safety of these artificial sweeteners with our Market Analysts as well:

"I will say that, in speaking with some of my dietitian colleagues, they probably would prioritize the natural sweeteners over the artificial sweeteners."

Thermo Fisher also has software that companies can use to track the analytics of each batch of sweeteners.

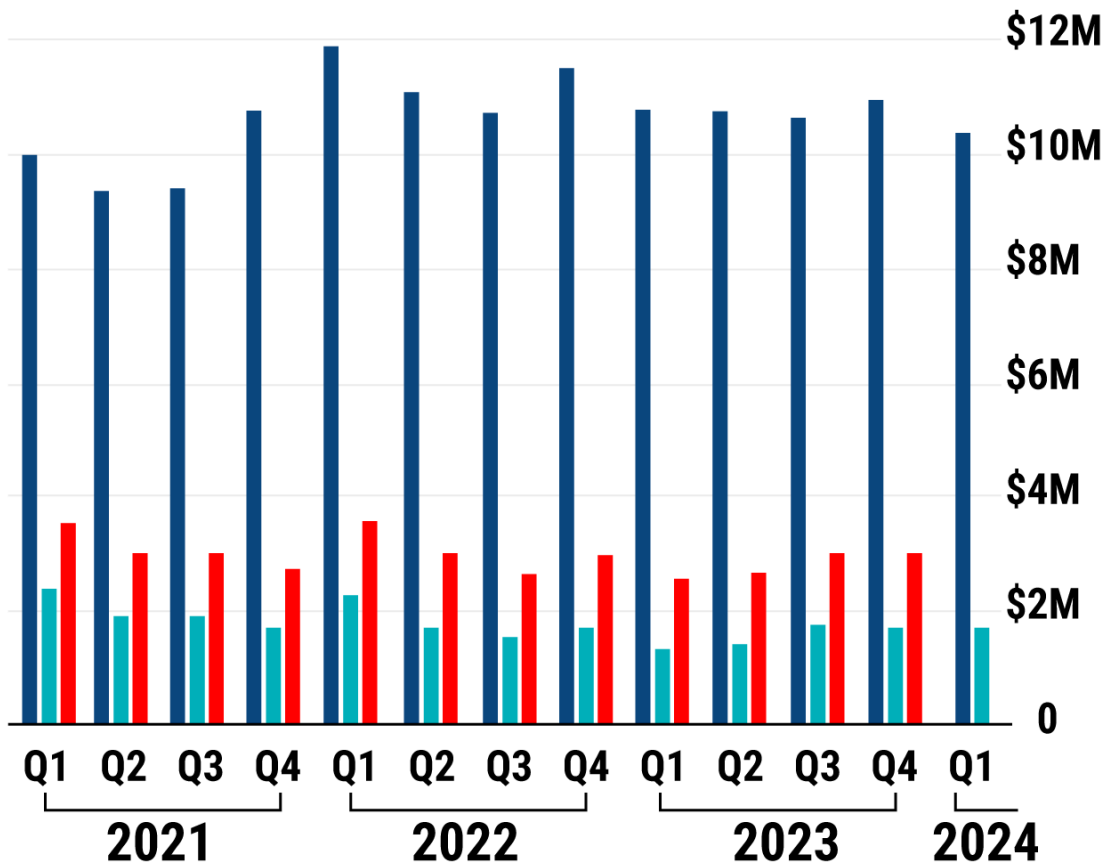
In 2024, Thermo Fisher earned \$43 billion in total revenue, an increase from its original projection of \$42 billion.

# Thermo Fisher Scientific Inc (TMO)

Revenue

Net Income

EBITDA



Market Briefs Pro

Data via Yahoo! Finance

And while it doesn't break down how much of that came specifically from aspartame tools and equipment, it did note in its 10-K that a small portion of its overall revenue is from the sales of these tools.

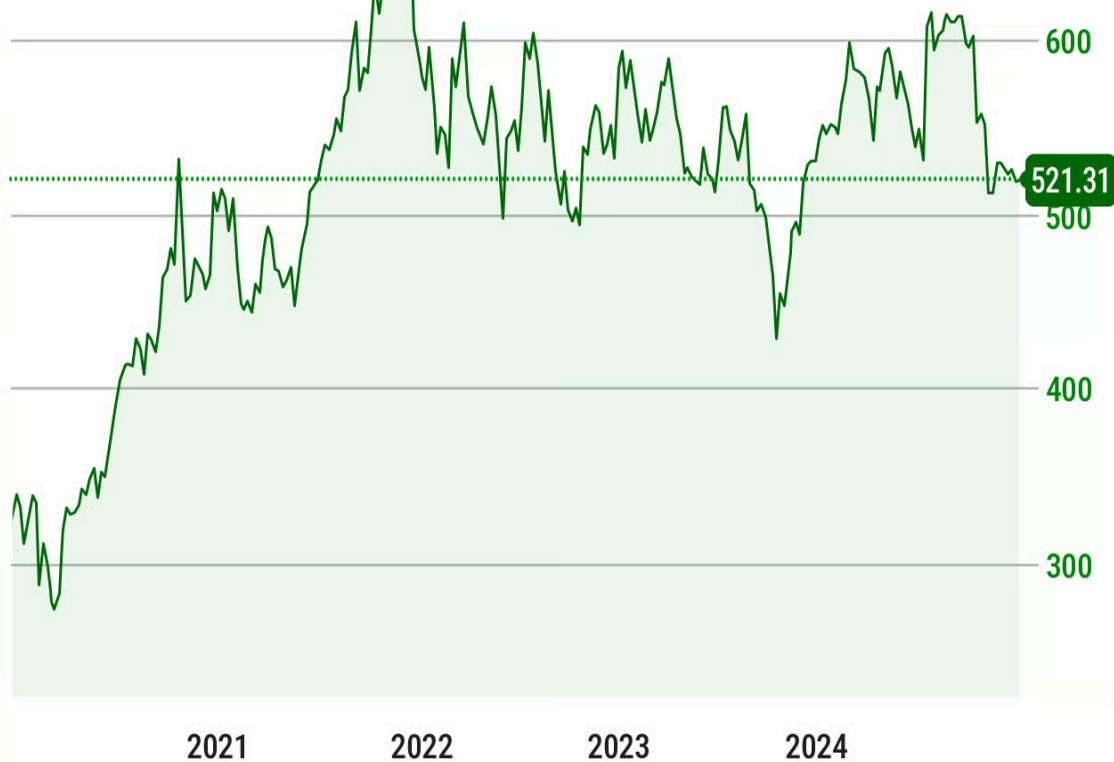
In fact, Thermo Fisher has started to use its tools to make aspartame, which it claims is 98% pure, one of the highest purities on the market.

Its aspartame creation business is mostly experimental now, but is mostly used as a way to showcase how effective its products and services are to other businesses.

# Thermo Fisher Scientific Inc. (TMO)

5 Year Price →

**521.31**  
**(+60.47%)**



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

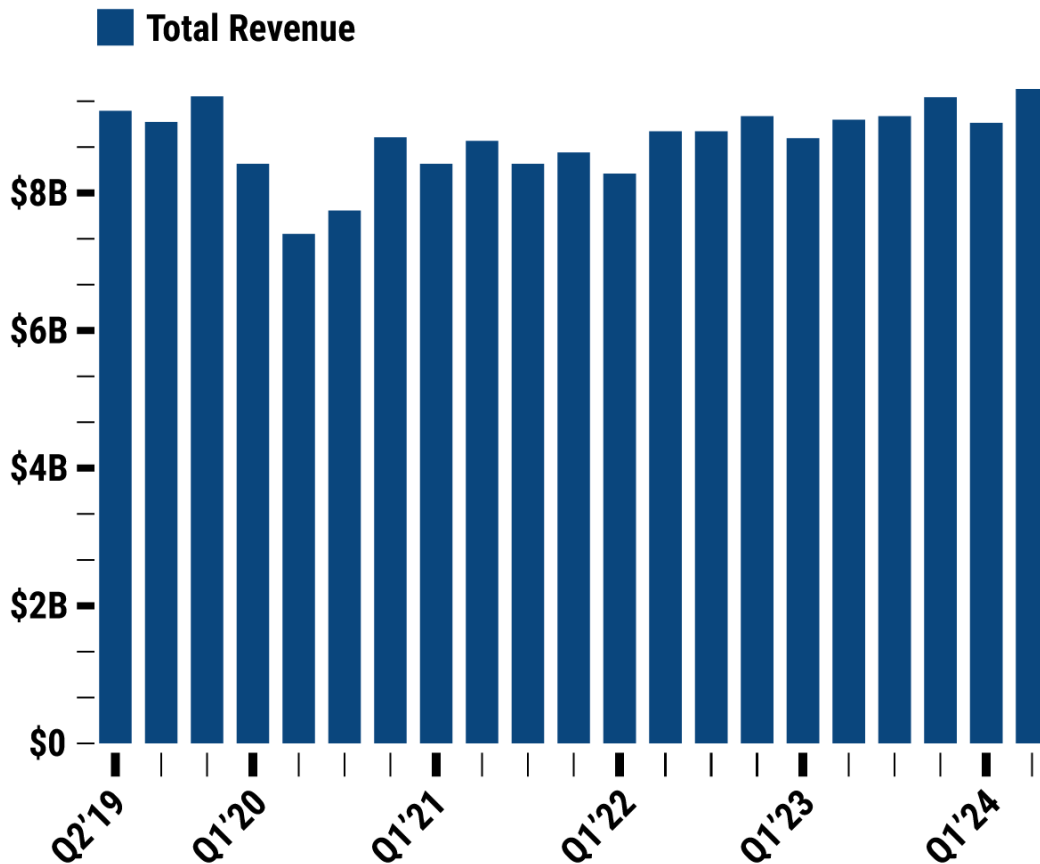
Honeywell (HON) is another company benefiting from the increase in demand for artificial sweeteners.

**How?** Honeywell produces hydrogen fluoride and solvents that can increase the reliability of each batch of sweetener made, as well as the speed.

On the flipside, Honeywell specializes in research and monitoring tech, which is mostly built for consumers, but is now being specialized for businesses in the artificial sweetener space.

Honeywell's science factories allow it to monitor the creation of aspartame and sucralose on a producer's behalf, and they even do most of it virtually.

# Honeywell Total Revenue



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- These life science facilities function like mini data centers - they store and track all the info the equipment in sweetener factories produce and make adjustments to formulas via the cloud.

Honeywell has seen its revenue rise in 7 of the last 8 quarters, and its revenue hit an almost record high of \$8.5 billion in Q2 2024.

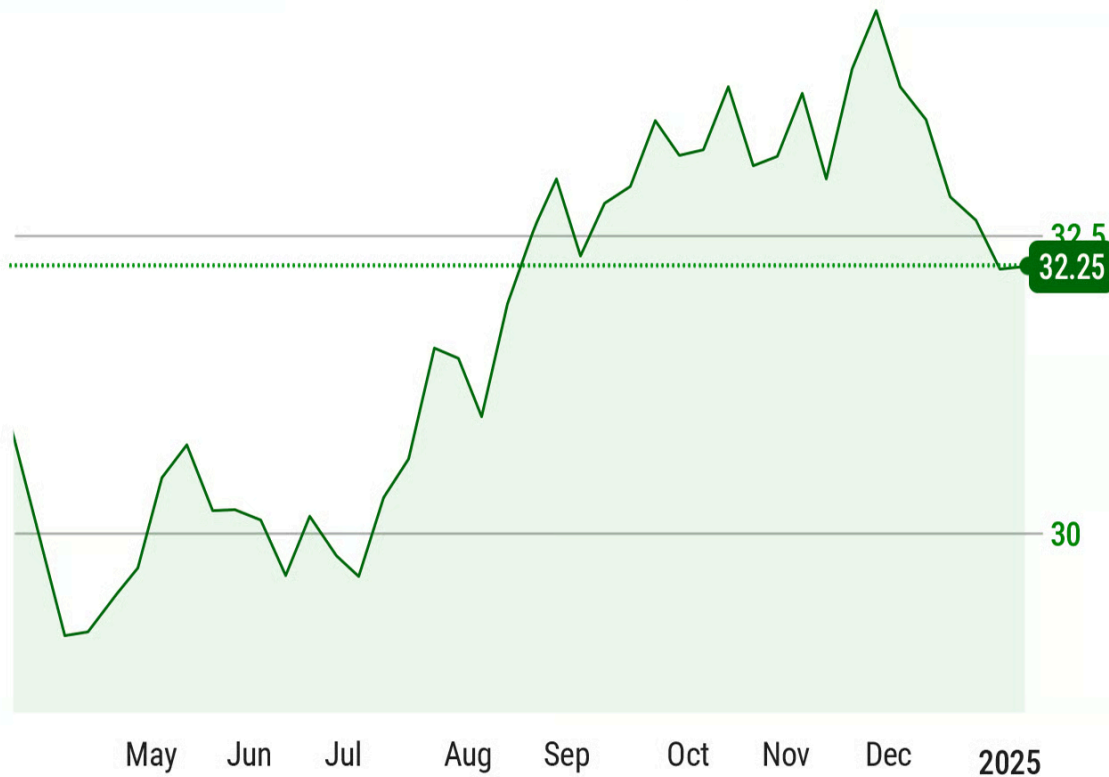
**The bottom line:** Equipment and providers like Honeywell and Thermo Fisher are earning more by providing services to artificial sweetener producers, creating profit opportunities for investors.

VanEck Morningstar Wide Moat Value ETF (MVAL) may also help investors profit from the growing demand for artificial sweeteners.

# VanEck Morningstar Wide Moat Value ETF (MVAL)

1 Year Price →

**32.25**  
**(+4.88%)**



 **Market Briefs Pro**

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

## REVIEW

### Sweet Opportunities Ahead

Sugar spending is going down - but consumers buying sweet treats is not.

That's created more demand for alternatives like sucralose and aspartame and the companies that produce and provide the equipment and ingredients for them.

And that could mean we see more businesses choosing artificial sweeteners for their products, that natural sugar.

"Keto and low carb diets weren't really around 10 years ago - so how do you keep a product low carb? You have to use some sort of sweetener, right? You can't use sugar. So because of that trend, I think it's possible that we all as consumers are not realizing that we are increasing our intake of some of these compounds." - Dr. Lee

Still, investors can profit from this rise in demand for artificial sweeteners and more importantly, the companies behind the scenes making the profits sweet.



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